

HLT: Week 1 - Fall 2026

Editorial review draft — September 28–October 4. Not published. Copy review only; existing newspaper artwork and layout are unchanged.

Front Page

SIX AGAINST? SOMEBODY CHECK THE DAMN LOCKS

Bad Bunny opens with a 6–2 thumping. Foote gives the Flyers a reason to strut. First General gets an early reminder that defence is not an optional subscription.

Listen, you can spend all summer talking about the new season. Then somebody hangs six on you and the conversation gets a hell of a lot shorter.

Bad Bunny handed First General London a 6–2 opening-night loss, while the FitzRays Flyers beat Liuna Premier 4–3. Two very different defeats: Liuna missed the points by a goal; First General needs to find a way to make its next opponent less comfortable on the scoreboard.

The early difference? Help. Trevor Paterson had a big night, but Bad Bunny also got offence from its blue line and goals from across the lineup. Jonathan Brougham figured in both First General goals. Good for Brougham. Less good for a team that cannot expect one fellow to bring the entire lunch.

Everybody has played once. Nobody has a season-long slump and nobody has won a damn thing yet. These are opening impressions. Bad Bunny's was excellent. First General's needs editing.

This Week on the Ice

FitzRays Flyers 4, Liuna Premier 3 — Put a Foote in the Door

Jack Foote scored twice and assisted on another Flyers goal. In a one-goal win, that is not decorative scoring. That is the difference between enjoying the standings and staring at them like they owe you money.

Steve Almond supplied a goal and an assist, Cooper Hatfield scored, and the Flyers had eight skaters collect a point. That is the encouraging part for FitzRays: Foote gets the headline, but there is more on the menu. Paul Gibson, Dhurim Ismaili, Mitch Bedard and defencemen Daryl Patterson and Jeff Lobodzinski each contributed an assist.

Steven Wild's recorded line shows three against and a win. Not a shutout, not a reason to commission a statue—enough to get the job done. The Flyers should take the points without deciding they have solved defensive hockey.

Liuna's Stefan Kowlessar, Cameron Sheppard and Dan MacGillivray each scored. Lyndon Bulda, Eric Mortson and Jim Bloxam added assists. Three goals and a one-goal defeat: there is something to build on here, even if “something to build on” tastes like absolute shit when the other team gets the points.

Aaron Buehler's recorded line has four against. That puts improvement on the agenda, not every ounce of blame on the goalie. Liuna needs the next save and the next goal; the skaters cannot outsource both jobs to the fellow in the big pads. Another contribution beyond those opening-night scorers could be the difference next week.

Bad Bunny 6, First General London 2 — Brougham Cannot Bring Everybody's Lunch

Trevor Paterson put up two goals and an assist, but treating this as a one-man show would miss what should worry the rest of the league. Eric Hartley, Matt Grossi and Adrian Hartley each had a goal and an assist. Ash Moore scored as well. Shut down Paterson and there are still other names capable of ruining your evening.

And look at the blue line. Adrian Hartley, Kyle Geraghty and Vince Carducci combined for a goal and four assists. Geraghty went goalless and still collected two helpers. Anybody calling that an empty night needs to learn what the second column is for. Cameron Wallace added an assist, too.

First General got a goal and an assist from Jonathan Brougham, plus a goal from Garrett Mcinerney. Brougham had a hand in both goals. When your offence depends that heavily on one name, the opposition's homework gets a lot easier.

Cody Bolman's recorded line shows six against. He needs a better result next time. So does the entire team. Hanging the whole mess on the goalie would be lazy bullshit: a final score does not tell you who missed a check, who lost a man or which puck should have been stopped. What it does say is that First General cannot make six against the price of admission and expect two goals to cover the bill.

Three Stars of the Week

1. Jack Foote — FitzRays Flyers

2 goals, 1 assist, 3 points.

Two goals of his own and a hand in another, in a game decided by one. You want to know who mattered? Start there. Foote gets the first chair because that production meant a hell of a lot in a tight result.

2. Trevor Paterson — Bad Bunny

2 goals, 1 assist, 3 points.

The sharp end of a six-goal opener. Paterson and Foote share the week's scoring lead; Paterson's next problem is that being this noticeable makes you everybody else's pre-game conversation. Good. Make them worry.

3. Adrian Hartley — Bad Bunny

1 goal, 1 assist, 2 points.

A defenceman bringing offence in a 6–2 win earns some ink. Hartley gave Bad Bunny another scoring threat instead of leaving every bit of the fun to the forwards. That is a useful habit to take into Week 2.

This Week by the Numbers

- **15 goals:** A busy opening slate. The league did not ease into the scoring.
- **4-goal margin:** Bad Bunny's advantage over First General. No need for a forensic investigation into one unlucky bounce.
- **3 points each:** Foote and Paterson set the opening pace. The rest of the league has its first names to circle.
- **1 goal, 4 assists:** Bad Bunny's production from Hartley, Geraghty and Carducci on defence. The back end brought more than shin pads.
- **2 games:** Enough for bragging rights. Nowhere near enough for a coronation.

Standings — Enjoy the View; You Have Not Bought the Place

Bad Bunny leads the table with two points and a plus-four goal difference. The Flyers also have two points, at plus-one. Liuna sits third at minus-one; First General is fourth at minus-four. Both are still looking for their first points.

For Bad Bunny, the next test is repeatability. Six goals makes a lovely first impression; another win would give it some weight. FitzRays has the points but less room for smugness after allowing three. Liuna's task is to turn a narrow defeat into an actual result. First General's is more basic: reduce the goals against before planning a scoring parade.

The Heater

Bad Bunny's Defence Brought the Ammunition

Adrian Hartley scored and assisted. Kyle Geraghty supplied two assists. Vince Carducci added another. Three defencemen, five points, and a useful warning for Liuna: watch Paterson, absolutely, but do not become so obsessed with the finisher that you forget the fellows supplying the puck. Geraghty does not need to score himself to make your goalie miserable.

The Cold Tub

First General: Six Against Buys the Whole Team a Seat

Six goals against is a team problem until there is evidence that makes it somebody else's. Bolman needs a bounce-back. The skaters need to help deliver one. Brougham and Mcinerney need company on the scoresheet. Nobody should be satisfied with this opener—but nobody gets to turn one bad game into a season obituary, either. Fix it Thursday. That is a more useful response than finding a scapegoat.

Next Week Headlines — Thursday, October 8

HLT's fictional Vegas-style lines are for fun, not real sportsbook prices. These are tie-no-bet lines: a tie refunds the imaginary wager. The model uses the opening results with heavy small-sample smoothing. Score picks are the columnist's opinions, not simulated results. Attendance and starting goalies are not confirmed.

Liuna Premier at Bad Bunny — 10:15 p.m.

HLT line: Bad Bunny -150 / Liuna Premier +150

Columnist's pick: Bad Bunny 5–3

If Jim Bloxam dresses, my assignment for the Liuna defenceman is simple: make Trevor Paterson earn every inch. Two goals and an assist in the opener is plenty of warning. Do not give the leading scorer the good china and ask whether he would like more room.

If Aaron Buehler starts, Geraghty's passing is worth his attention. Two assists is an opening-night warning, not a career résumé—but a goalie who watches only the shooter can end up chasing the next pass. Liuna needs sticks in those lanes and somebody accounting for Paterson when the puck moves.

Kowlessar, Sheppard and MacGillivray supplied Liuna's goals last week. The route to an upset is another contribution from that group, help beyond it, and a tighter result at the other end. Bad Bunny's route is to keep spreading the offence. I like the Bunny. Liuna can change my mind by making that comfortable committee do some uncomfortable work.

First General London at FitzRays Flyers — 10:30 p.m.

HLT line: FitzRays Flyers -150 / First General London +150

Columnist's pick: FitzRays Flyers 5–2

If Cory Nott dresses, I would put “make Jack Foote sick of seeing you” near the top of the First General defenceman's job description. Foote just had three points. Giving him room to repeat the performance would be a terrible damn idea. Almond also has a goal and an assist; First General cannot solve one problem by ignoring the next one.

If Bolman gets the start, he needs a bounce-back with better help, not a motivational speech delivered after another six have gone in. Brougham and Mcinerney need to produce again, but somebody else has to join the conversation.

For the Flyers, Daryl Patterson and Jeff Lobodzinski should have Brougham circled. If Wild starts, he needs to respect both the shot and the pass: Brougham scored one First General goal and assisted on the other. Cut down that influence and you make someone else beat you.

I am taking FitzRays because its opening-night scoring was broader. First General's rebuttal belongs on the ice. We have heard enough speeches. Go make the pick look stupid.

Editorial source note

Scores, scoring contributions, positions, standings and fixtures were checked against the current Hockey Life game pages, Stats and Schedule. Goalie discussion uses recorded results and goals against, not unverified save totals or shot-quality claims. Bad Bunny's opening-game goalie is not identified in the current-season public goalie records, so no individual performance is invented. There is not yet enough Fall 2026 history to report an established scorer's season slump. No published article or live generator was changed for this review draft.